Elegantly solved.

Hemlo is an Iraq-first software company that builds small, focused products for the everyday work of businesses. We study the work first. Then we build the simplest thing that fits it.

حلولٌ بإتقان.



Hemlo هيملو

ONE LETTER, ONE SHAPE, ONE COLOUR

01

Brand Essence

The one idea everything else answers to.

CENTRAL BRAND IDEA

Understand the work, then make it simple.

BRAND ESSENCE

Earns its place.

Every product, screen, feature and sentence has to justify being in someone's working day. If it doesn't, it goes.

Choosing the conceptual territory

TERRITORY	WHAT IT GETS RIGHT	WHY IT ISN'T THE CORE	VERDICT
A. Solve complexity	Echoes the name	Leans on a pun, and every software company claims it	Reject
B. Make work simpler	True to the product	Generic. Better as a principle than as the idea	Principle
C. Software for real life	Grounded	"Real life" is vague. Stronger as the photography direction	Imagery
D. Practical technology for Iraq	Honest origin	Makes Iraq a ceiling instead of a starting point	Proof point
E. Turn friction into flow	Easy to animate	Motion-graphics cliché; says nothing specific	Reject
F. Build what businesses actually need	Customer-first	Implies everyone else doesn't, which is combative and hard to prove	Internal value
G. From problem to product	**Describes the method *and* the portfolio model: one studied problem, one focused product**	Needs a sharper expression for customers, which is "earns its place"	Core
H. The software layer for everyday business	Big ambition	Platform language five years too early; claims infrastructure that doesn't exist yet	Later

G wins because it is true on day one and still true with ten products. It turns Hemlo's actual behaviour (research first, focused scope) into the brand, so the brand can't drift away from how the company works.

Positioning statement

For Iraqi businesses whose daily work runs on WhatsApp, notebooks and spreadsheets, Hemlo builds focused software products, each designed around one job we have studied inside real workplaces. Unlike general ERPs and imported tools, a Hemlo product does its one job completely, fits how Iraqi businesses actually operate, and has to prove its value in daily use.

Manifesto

Most work in Iraq already has a system. It's a notebook, a WhatsApp group, a stamp and a person who remembers everything.

We don't pretend that system is broken. We study it, find the parts that cost people time or money, and build software only for those parts.

Small products. Real problems. Plain words. Software that works when the signal drops and the day gets busy.

If it doesn't earn its place, we don't ship it.

Company description	Hemlo is an Iraqi software company that builds focused products for the everyday operations of businesses.
Elevator pitch	A lot of Iraqi businesses run on WhatsApp, paper and memory, and it mostly works until money or time starts slipping through the gaps. Hemlo studies those gaps one industry at a time and builds small, focused software for them. Each product does one job properly, works in Arabic, in dinars, on a phone, with patchy internet, and it only stays in our lineup if people keep using it.
Website hero	**Elegantly solved.** Software that earns its place: focused tools for the everyday work of Iraqi businesses, built after we've watched the work being done.

02

Positioning

Practical claims only. Everything here should be defensible in a conversation with a sceptical shop owner.

Purpose	Turn the repeated, error-prone parts of everyday work into software simple enough to use every day.
Promise	Each Hemlo product does one job completely, and does it the way your business actually works.
Values	**Understand first** (no code before we've seen the work) · **One job, done completely** · **Plain words** · **Built for real conditions** (weak signal, cash, Arabic, paper) · **Earn trust slowly** (no promises we can't keep)
Differentiation	Not a generic ERP with 40 modules and not a translated foreign tool. Hemlo is a portfolio of narrow products, each built from field research in Iraqi workplaces, sharing one account, one design language and one support standard.
Target audience	Owners and operators of Iraqi small and medium businesses, plus the accountants, technicians and staff who do the daily work.
Functional benefit	Fewer lost records, fewer phone calls asking for status, faster reports and a clear view of money and work.
Emotional benefit	The owner feels in control without becoming a software administrator. Staff feel the tool is on their side.
Reason to believe	Verifiable from day one: every product starts with published field research, has a narrow scope, and handles Iraqi specifics (IQD, landmark addresses, Arabic and Kurdish, WhatsApp delivery, offline use). Customer proof is added only as it is earned.

03

Mission & Vision

MISSION

Build focused software for the everyday work of Iraqi businesses, one real problem at a time.

VISION

A family of products that businesses across Iraq rely on daily, where "by Hemlo" means the software was built by people who understood the work.

04

Audience

Who each group is, and what they need to believe before they'll use a Hemlo product.

AUDIENCE	WHAT THEY ARE LIKE	WHAT THEY NEED TO HEAR
Owners of small and medium businesses (primary)	Busy, sceptical of software, burned by systems nobody used, decides fast once trust exists	"This does one thing you already do, faster, and your staff will actually use it."
Operators and staff (primary): accountants, technicians, admins, cashiers	Mobile-first, low tolerance for complex screens, judged on mistakes	"Less typing, fewer mistakes, proof you did your job."
Growing companies (20–100 people)	Have outgrown WhatsApp but don't want a heavy ERP	"Structure without a six-month implementation."
Developers and tech professionals (secondary)	Judge by craft, stack and honesty	"Real engineering on real problems, written up openly."
Partners, future hires, investors (secondary)	Want to know if this is serious and lasting	"A method, a portfolio logic and products with real users."
Consumers (future)	Meet Hemlo through a receipt link, a QR sticker or a status page	"This business is organised, and I can trust this link."

05

Personality

Grounded

Starts from what people really do, not from what software can do.

Precise

Exact numbers, exact words, exact alignment. Details are respect.

Calm

Never shouts. Confidence shows through restraint.

Plain-spoken

Talks like a capable colleague, in the customer's language.

Curious

Asks "show me how you do it now" before proposing anything.

Dependable

Keeps promises small and keeps all of them.

HEMLO IS	HEMLO IS NOT
Confident	Boastful ("the best", "revolutionary")
Simple	Empty or vague
Technical underneath	Technical on the surface (jargon, acronyms)
Warm	Cute, playful or full of emoji

HEMLO IS	HEMLO IS NOT
Serious	Corporate, bureaucratic or government-like
Iraqi in its details	Iraqi in its clichés
Ambitious in scope	Ambitious in claims

06

Brand Principles

Rules for product and design decisions. When two options compete, these break the tie.

1. Understand before building

No feature ships without a real example from a real workplace behind it.

2. One job, done completely

A narrow product that finishes the job beats a wide one that half-does ten.

3. Design for real conditions

Weak signal, a cracked phone, 48°C, cash, paper, Arabic. The hardest condition sets the standard.

4. Localise the details, not the decoration

IQD formatting, landmark addresses and WhatsApp delivery show you're Iraqi. Palm trees and lions don't.

5. Plain words, exact numbers

If a sentence needs a second read, rewrite it.

6. Quiet confidence

One strong idea per screen, one accent per page, no effects that exist only to impress.

07

Brand Story

Walk into almost any business in Iraq and you'll find a system that works better than outsiders expect. Orders arrive on WhatsApp. Debts live in a notebook by the till. A technician's day is planned in a phone call. Receipts are stamped, photographed and forwarded. Someone always remembers where everything is.

That system holds together until it doesn't: a payment nobody recorded, a customer who calls five times for an update, a report assembled by hand at midnight, a shipment held because one document was wrong. The cost is small each time and large over a year.

Hemlo started from a simple decision: don't build software for Iraq from a distance. Sit in the shop, read the notebook, follow the paperwork, then build only the part that genuinely needs software, and make that part simple enough to use on a busy day with a weak signal.

We're early. We don't claim to have transformed anyone's business. What we promise is a method: every Hemlo product starts with real work we've studied, does one job properly, and stays only if it keeps earning its place in people's days.

08

Naming Architecture

How products relate to the company, now and at ten products.

ARCHITECTURE	EXAMPLE	STRENGTH	WEAKNESS	VERDICT
A. Hemlo + descriptor	**Hemlo Studio · Hemlo Systems**	Every product builds one brand; instantly understood; cheapest to market	A weak product can hurt the parent; descriptors must be chosen carefully	Choose

ARCHITECTURE	EXAMPLE	STRENGTH	WEAKNESS	VERDICT
B. Descriptor by Hemlo	Workshop by Hemlo	Product leads, parent endorses	Generic words ("Workshop") can't be owned or searched	Endorsement line only
C. Independent names	Wasl, Fanni, Madrasa	Each product gets its own personality	Splits a tiny marketing budget across many names; parent stays invisible	Not now
D. Hemlo Core + verticals	Hemlo Core, Hemlo Retail	Signals shared platform	"Core" is internal architecture, not a customer benefit	Reject

Naming principles

- Name **what the customer manages**, not the industry. "Hemlo Import" reads like an importing company; **Hemlo Shipments** doesn't.
- One word, in plain English, that customers already say.
- Every product has a fixed Arabic descriptor, chosen for meaning rather than translated.
- No invented product words, no "Pro/Plus/AI", no numbers in names.
- Plans and editions are named by size (Starter, Team, Business), never by metals or gems.

Hierarchy and the exception rule

- **Level 1:** Hemlo (company, account, billing, support)
- **Level 2:** Hemlo + descriptor (products)
- **Level 3:** plain feature names inside products ("Deposit schedule", "Visit report"), never branded
- A product may earn an independent name only if it later serves a different audience that doesn't benefit from the parent, and it keeps the endorsement "by Hemlo".
- The branches are **Hemlo Tools** (free), **Hemlo Studio** (custom work), **Hemlo Systems** (ready-made systems, one edition per trade, starting with repair workshops) and **Hemlo School**.

BRANCH	ENGLISH LOCKUP	ARABIC LOCKUP	SPOKEN ARABIC
Free tools	Hemlo Tools	هيملو · الأدوات	أدوات هيملو
Custom websites, apps and systems	Hemlo Studio	هيملو · ستوديو	ستوديو هيملو
Ready-made systems for each trade	Hemlo Systems	هيملو · الأنظمة	هيملو أنظمة
School management	Hemlo School	هيملو · المدارس	هيملو للمدارس

In the logo, the branch name sits under the name in a lighter weight (Poppins Light / Vazirmatn Light), so it reads as a label. In running text it follows a middle dot. Written as a sentence ("هيملو للاستيراد") it would sound like the name of a trading company.

09

Tagline Exploration

#	TAGLINE	STYLE	NOTE
★	**Elegantly solved.**	Premium, concise	Chosen tagline: refined, carries the name, works in every context
1	**Software that earns its place.**	Product-minded	Kept as the supporting line under the tagline

#	TAGLINE	STYLE	NOTE
2	**From the notebook to the system.**	Iraqi-first, human	Names the real starting point
3	**Built from the work.**	Concise	Method in four words
4	Small products. Real problems.	Concise	Good internal motto; a little flat as a tagline
5	One job, done properly.	Product-minded	Better as a product-page line
6	We study the work first.	Human	Strong in research content
7	Made for the way work actually happens.	Human	Too long
8	Less software. More done.	Technical	Clever, and a common formula
9	Useful every day.	Concise	Honest but forgettable
10	The work, made simple.	Concise	Close to generic
11	Simple on the surface. Solid underneath.	Technical	Good for developer audiences
12	Every product starts on the shop floor.	Iraqi-first	Great for the "how we build" section
13	Built in Iraq, for work.	Iraqi-first	Limits future expansion
14	Quietly essential.	Ambitious	Sounds like a luxury brand
15	Software with its sleeves rolled up.	Human	Too cute for the personality

TAGLINE

Elegantly solved.

Two words, calm and confident. It pairs with the name: a hem is the finished edge that keeps fabric from fraying, and "elegantly solved" is that finish in software. "Elegantly" describes the whole identity: refined, precise, nothing extra. It works on a business card, a billboard, a website hero and a product screen.

SUPPORTING LINE

Software that earns its place.

The sentence under the tagline. It sets the standard every Hemlo product has to meet, and it stays the internal test for product decisions.

METHOD LINE

Built from the work.

For the "how we build" section and hiring.

Arabic tagline (written for Arabic readers, not translated)

حلولٌ بإتقان.

Formal Modern Standard Arabic, and a partner to the English rather than a translation. The English stresses refinement; the Arabic stresses mastery. «إتقان» is the strongest Arabic word for work done properly (precision, care and skill together), and the well-known saying «إن الله يحب إذا عمل أحدكم عملاً أن يتقنه» gives it real weight with Iraqi audiences. Formal alternative for documents: برمجيات تستحق مكانها في عملك اليومي.

10

Voice & Tone

A capable colleague who has visited your business, explaining something clearly on a busy day.

Voice principles

- **Specific over impressive.** "Send a visit report in one tap", not "streamline reporting".
- **Short sentences, active verbs.** One idea per sentence.
- **Customer's words.** "Debt", "receipt", "technician", never "AR ledger" or "workforce entity".
- **Numbers exact.** 1,250,000 IQD, not "over a million".
- **Technical depth on request.** Plain for owners; precise and open for developers.
- **Punctuation:** full stops, commas, colons for lists. No exclamation marks in product UI. No ALL CAPS sentences.

Arabic and English tone

- **English:** calm, direct, lightly warm. Sentence case everywhere.
- **Arabic product UI:** clear Modern Standard Arabic, short, no flowery openings ("نود أن نحيطكم علماً..." is banned).
- **Arabic marketing and social:** MSA with Iraqi warmth where it helps (الشغل، هسه sparingly). Never full dialect in written UI.
- **To owners:** money, time, control. **To staff:** less typing, fewer mistakes. **To developers:** architecture, trade-offs, what didn't work.
- **About products:** describe the job, show the screen, state the limit. "Hemlo Shipments doesn't file your customs declaration. Your broker still does."

Do

- "Your statement was sent to 42 customers on WhatsApp."
- "We watched 11 technicians work before designing this screen."
- "This works offline. Photos upload when you have signal."
- Admit limits and say what to do instead.

Don't

- "Revolutionise your workflow with smart AI-powered solutions!"
- "Oops! Something went wrong 😅"
- "Leading", "first", "best" without proof.
- Translate English copy line by line into Arabic.

CONTEXT	SAMPLE COPY
Website homepage	**Elegantly solved.** Software that earns its place. We build focused tools for the everyday work of Iraqi businesses. Each one starts with time spent inside real shops, offices and workshops, and does one job properly.
Product launch	**Hemlo Shipments is live.** One file per shipment: supplier documents, pre-declaration, bank transfer, duties and tax deposits in one place. It gives you your real landed cost and the deposit schedule your accountant needs before the importer-ID renewal. Built with 12 importers and 3 customs brokers over two months.
LinkedIn post	We spent last week in three auto-parts shops in Baghdad. Every one kept customer debts in the same kind of notebook, and every one had a page of corrections. The notebook isn't the problem. Finding last month's balance in 30 seconds is. Here's what we're testing next.
Product feature	**Deposit schedule.** Every tax deposit you pay at customs, matched to its shipment and receipt. Export it for your accountant in one tap.
Customer announcement	From 1 November, Hemlo accounts can pay by FIB transfer as well as cash. Nothing changes in your plan or your data.
Error message	The photo didn't upload because there's no internet. It's saved on this phone and will upload automatically when you're back online. ما تم رفع الصورة لعدم وجود اتصال بالإنترنت. الصورة محفوظة على الهاتف وسترفع تلقائياً عند عودة الاتصال.
Onboarding	Start with one real shipment. Add the supplier invoice you already have; we'll show you what's missing. ابدأ بشحنة حقيقية واحدة. أضف فاتورة المورّد الموجودة عندك، وسنوضّح لك ما ينقصها.

The launch and LinkedIn samples use example numbers. Publish real ones only when they are true.

Logo Concepts

The final mark was drawn by the founder. The concepts explored on the way are kept as a record. Symbols are shown on the same 24-unit grid.



FINAL · V1 · FOUNDER'S DRAWING

1 · The H

Idea	A single, soft H. Two swelling stems, rounded at every end, joined by a crossbar that slopes gently down to the right. One shape, no parts, no outline.
Metaphor	Fabric turned and stitched at a hem: soft, finished and strong. The stems read like two folded panels; the crossbar is the seam that holds them. No loose threads.
Geometry	Drawn freehand as one closed path, then fitted to a 24-unit grid at 22 high (about 0.65 : 1). The left stem sits higher than the right, so the letter leans into a quiet forward motion. Never redrawn; every file is generated from the master.
Why it works	Most H marks are two posts and a bar. This one has weight, softness and movement, so it is recognisable as a shape before it is read as a letter, which is what an app icon needs.
Strengths	Bold at 16px, calm at billboard size, one colour everywhere. The name is set beside it in Readex Pro, whose round, open shapes match the stems.
Watch for	Its softness depends on the curves; it must never be traced into straight lines, outlined, or set in a font "H" as a shortcut.
App icon / company	Excellent / excellent.



EARLIER FOUNDER'S DRAWING

2 · HEMLO with the split O

Idea	Heavy capitals with the O cut in two by one diagonal seam.
Why it moved on	The split O carried too much of the idea and read as Ø or a "no" sign on its own; the name is better led by its first letter.



EXPLORED

3 · The Stitch

Idea	An H of two angled planes held together by two slanted stitches.
Why it moved on	Sharp and architectural; the founder's soft H is warmer and more ownable.



REJECTED · TOO BASIC

4 · The Fold

Idea	A rounded H with a soft fold in the crossbar.
Why it was rejected	Clean but generic.



RETIRED · FORMER NAME

5 · The Seal

Idea	The round mark of the old name: a disc cut in two by one continuous seam.

The Logo: the H

One soft letter, drawn once and never redrawn. The name sits beside it in Readex Pro; the H alone is the icon.











Hemlo
Studio

BRANCH · THE H TAKES THE BRANCH COLOUR, THE NAME GOES UNDER

Lockup family

All lockups are outlined vectors, so no fonts are needed. The Arabic and Kurdish names are shaped with HarfBuzz from Vazirmatn (weight 600) and merged into single paths. In right-to-left lockups the H sits on the right, at the start of the line, and is never mirrored.



Hemlo

هیملو

STACKED BILINGUAL · SIGNAGE, AVATARS, COVER PAGES



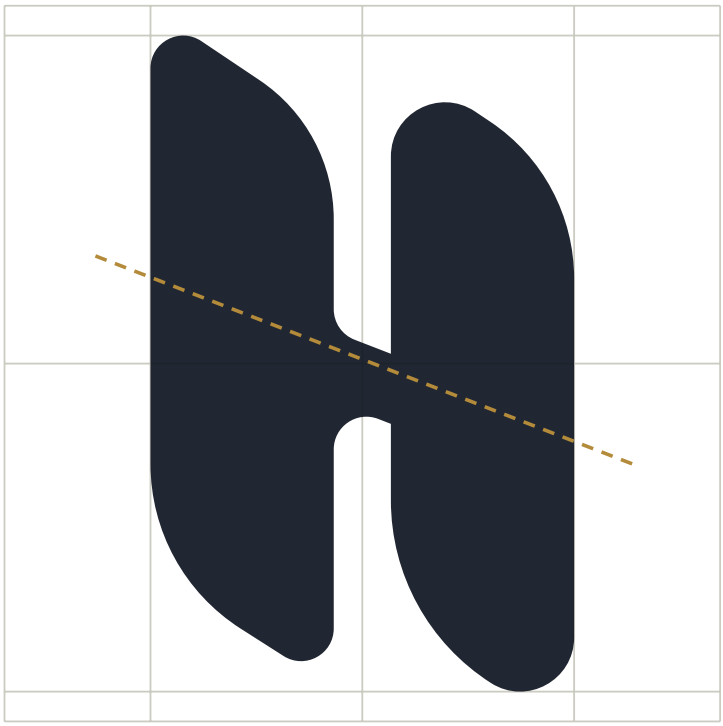
BILINGUAL HORIZONTAL · DOCUMENTS, WEBSITE HEADER





ARABIC · KURDISH SORANI

Construction



height 22

width 14.2

slope 21°

one path

24 grid · from the master drawing

Proportions

One closed shape, about 0.65 wide to 1 high. The left stem starts higher and the right stem ends lower, so the H leans gently forward; the crossbar between them slopes down to the right at about 21°. Every end is rounded, and the stems swell slightly towards their ends, which is what makes the mark feel soft rather than drawn with a ruler. In the horizontal lockup the H is 1.4 × the cap height of the name, centred on the capitals, with a gap of 0.44 × the cap height.

Clear space

Half the width of the H on all sides, for the mark and for every lockup.

Minimum size

Mark: 16px on screen (it has no fine detail, so there is no separate small cut). Horizontal lockup: 88px wide on screen, 22 mm in print. Mark in print: 5 mm high.

Wordmark

"Hemlo" in title case, set in **Poppins SemiBold (600)** at −1% tracking and outlined, so no font is needed. Poppins is geometric and round, so it sits calmly beside the soft H without competing with it. **Branch lockups** put the branch name under "Hemlo" in **Poppins Light (300)** at 0.58 × the cap height, and the H grows to span both lines. Headlines stay in Readex Pro; Poppins is reserved for the logo

Incorrect usage

- Redrawing, tracing, straightening or "cleaning up" the H; always use the master files.
- Rotating, mirroring or slanting it, including in right-to-left layouts.
- Replacing it with a letter H from a font.

- Outlines, strokes, split colours or gradients inside the H; it is always one solid colour.
- Adding a ring, a border or stamp-style text around it (the company stamp is the one exception).
- Shadows, 3D or bevels on screen (emboss, foil and brass are for physical objects only).

- Placing it on busy photos without a solid plate.
- Brass as the only colour at small sizes (too little contrast).
- Setting the name in a different font or weight next to the H.

Color Exploration

Three directions, judged on distinctiveness, working range in a dashboard and associations in Iraq.

CHOSEN

A · Kohl & Brass

Deep blue-black ink, muted brass, cool stone neutrals. Brass references Baghdad's coppersmiths' market (Souq al-Safafeer): craft, tools and precision, not luxury. Ink carries the seriousness; brass appears sparingly. It belongs to no big software brand.



B · Graphite & Signal Cobalt

Near-black graphite with a saturated cobalt. Clean and safe, but it reads as every developer tool and sits close to the blues of Atlassian and Microsoft. Rejected for lacking a point of view.



C · Tigris Green & Sand

Deep river green with sand neutrals. Warm and local, but green reads as banking and fintech, overlaps with the flag and with Careem, and warm sand drifts toward the overused cream look. Rejected.



Final Color System

Ink carries the identity and all primary actions. Brass is a signature, used sparingly. Status colours are strictly separate from brand colours.

Brand

Kohl Ink
#0E1420
Logo, text, primary buttons

Ink 700
#2B3445
Secondary text on light, dark surfaces

Safafeer Brass
#B38B3A
The H in brand moments, highlights (3.2:1 on white, non-text only)

Brass 700
#8A6A22
Accent text and links on light (5.0:1)

Brass 300
#D7B46A
Accent on dark

Slate
#5E6776
Muted text (5.8:1 on white)

Neutrals

White
#FFFFFF
App surfaces, documents

Stone 50
#F7F7F4
Marketing background

Stone 100
#EFEFEA
Panels, sidebars

Stone 200
#E2E2DB
Borders

Night
#0C111A
Dark background

Night raised
#1A2230
Dark surfaces

Semantic (never used as brand colour)

Success
#1F7A4D
Paid, completed

Warning
#B8520A
Due soon, missing document

Danger
#B42331
Overdue, failed

Info
#2F5DA8
In progress, notes

Product accents (the H in product lockups, product navigation indicator)

Tools
#3B5BC4

Studio
#0F766E

Systems
#A8532E

School
#6E4A86

Retail
#5F7A2E

Usage ratio



Roughly 60 stone, 25 white, 10 ink, 4 brass, 1 product accent. If brass exceeds about 5% of a screen, it stops being a signature.

Charts and dark mode

Chart series order: Ink 700, Brass, Studio teal, Tools blue, School plum, Slate. Status is never shown in series colours. In dark mode, the primary button becomes stone-on-night, brass shifts to Brass 300, and borders carry the structure because shadows disappear.

15

Typography

Three families on Google Fonts, all free, covering English, Arabic and Kurdish Sorani.

DISPLAY · LATIN	**Readex Pro: built from the work.**
TEXT & UI · LATIN	IBM Plex Sans. Engineered, very readable at 13–16px, with true tabular figures for invoices and tables.
DATA · LATIN	SHP-2026-0142 · HS 8415.10 · 1,250,000 IQD
DISPLAY · ARABIC	**برمجيات تستحق مكانها**
TEXT & UI · ARABIC	نوتو سانس العربي للنصوص والواجهات: واضح بالأحجام الصغيرة، ويدعم الكردية.
KURDISH SORANI	ڕۆژێکی باش لە هێملۆ — پسوولە، قەرز، هەڵگرتن
MIXED DIRECTION	رقم الشحنة SHP-2026-0142 · المبلغ 1,250,000 د.ع

Why these faces

- **Readex Pro** has editorial character without trendiness. It sets the name beside the H, so headlines and logo agree; its rounded, open letters echo the soft stems of the mark.
- **IBM Plex Sans + Mono** suit the "engineered" personality and handle dense numbers well. Plex is used for Latin only.
- **Vazirmatn** (display) has square, geometric forms that echo the mark. **Vazirmatn** (text) is highly legible and supports Sorani.
- IBM Plex Sans Arabic was rejected: it has an open, unresolved rendering bug for Central Kurdish.
- Noto Kufi Arabic was replaced by Vazirmatn: Kufi's square geometry fought the soft H, while Vazirmatn is rounded, modern and supports every Sorani letter (ڤ ڵ ۆ ێ ێ).

Arabic rhythm rules

- Arabic sets one step larger than Latin at the same role, with line-height 1.7–1.8 (Latin 1.5).
- Never letter-space Arabic; never use kashida to justify text in the UI.
- Arabic punctuation: ، ؟ ؛ and « » quotes. Don't mix in Latin commas.
- Digits: Western 0–9 in product UI and documents for IDs, phones and money. Eastern Arabic digits are optional in editorial Arabic, never mixed in one table.
- Currency: `1,250,000` د.ع in Arabic, `1,250,000 IQD` in English. No decimals.

ROLE	LATIN	ARABIC	SIZE / LINE-HEIGHT
Marketing H1	Readex Pro 700, −2%	Vazirmatn 700	56–68 / 1.05 (AR 1.3)
H2	Readex Pro 700	Vazirmatn 600	32–38 / 1.1
H3 / card title	Readex Pro 600	Vazirmatn 600	20 / 1.3
Body	Plex Sans 400	Vazirmatn 400	16 / 1.6 (AR 17 / 1.8)
UI text, navigation	Plex Sans 500	Vazirmatn 500	14 / 1.45 (AR 15 / 1.6)
Labels	Plex Mono 500, caps, +8%	Vazirmatn 600 (no caps)	11–12
Numbers in tables	Plex Sans, tabular	Western digits, tabular	13–14

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Arabic Identity

One name, written three ways for three scripts and audiences, never translated.

OPTION	ASSESSMENT	VERDICT
Hemlo only	Clean internationally, but Arabic-first customers can't say or search it confidently	Not alone

OPTION	ASSESSMENT	VERDICT
هیملو	Readable to every Arabic reader; ي carries the long "e" and و the final "o"	Arabic name
هێملۆ	Kurdish Sorani spelling, with ێ and ۆ for the exact vowels	Kurdish name
Hemlo | هیملو	The bilingual lockup for signage, documents and the website header	Bilingual lockup



ARABIC LOCKUP



BILINGUAL, STACKED



KURDISH SORANI

Arabic wordmark treatment

Set in Vazirmatn Bold (700), shaped with HarfBuzz and outlined. Its soft, even strokes sit naturally beside Readex Pro and the rounded H. In the bilingual lockup both names are centred on the Latin cap height, with a brass rule between them. The symbol always sits at the start of the line. In right-to-left layouts it moves to the right side without being mirrored.

Arabic taglines

- حلولٌ بإتقان. Primary Arabic tagline (website, marketing, social, stationery).
- كل حلّ في مكانه. Secondary line for editorial and product pages.
- برمجيات تستحق مكانها في عملك اليومي. Formal (documents, proposals).
- من الدفتر إلى النظام. Campaign line ("From the notebook to the system").

Arabic website behaviour

- Arabic is the default for visitors in Iraq; English is one tap away and remembered.
- The whole layout mirrors (navigation, icons with direction, progress); the logo, charts' time axis and phone numbers do not.
- Arabic copy is written separately from English, with the same structure and different sentences.
- Fonts switch by `lang` attribute, never by guessing from characters.

Kurdish without redesign

- Vazirmatn covers every Sorani letter (ڕ ڵ ۆ ێ ھ ڤ), in display and text weights.
- Kurdish name: هێملۆ. Same lockup rules as Arabic.
- Add a `ckb` locale file and a Kurdish copywriter; no visual changes.
- Badini (Latin-script Kurdish) uses the Latin system as it is.

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Iconography

System

- Base set: **Lucide** (open source, 1,500+ icons), so a solo founder never draws routine icons.
- 24px grid, **1.75 stroke** (Lucide's 2 is slightly heavy next to Plex), round caps and joins.
- Outline by default; filled only for the active state in navigation.
- Sizes: 16 (inline), 20 (buttons, tables), 24 (navigation), 32 (empty states).
- Icon colour follows text colour. Never brass except the active product indicator.
- Custom icons (QR tag, deposit, landmark address) are drawn on the same grid and stroke.

Right-to-left rules

- Mirror anything that shows direction or sequence: arrows, back/forward, send, reply, progress, list indent, "next".
- Don't mirror clocks, checkmarks, play buttons, search, cameras, phones, charts, or anything representing a real object.
- Mirror with CSS (`[dir=rtl] .icon-dir{transform:scaleX(-1)}`) on a flagged subset, not globally.

18

Imagery

Documentary, not staged. The subject is the work and the tools people already use.

What we photograph

- **The workaround**, Hemlo's signature subject: the debt notebook by the till, the stamped receipt, the WhatsApp group on a cracked phone, the Excel sheet printed and annotated.
- Hands at work: a technician's hands on an outdoor AC unit, an accountant's desk with invoices, a broker's folder at a port office.
- Real places: shop counters, workshops, warehouses, market lanes, rooftops, offices with plastic chairs and good light.
- Product in context: the phone in a real hand in a real place, not floating.

How it looks

- Natural light, slightly cool, true colour. No teal-orange grading, no heavy filters.
- Eye-level or over-the-shoulder; people doing, not posing. Faces only with written consent.
- Shot by Iraqi photographers in real businesses that agreed to take part. Credit them.
- Never: handshakes, pointing at charts, laptop-and-latte offices, stock "Arab businessman", skyline composites.
- Blur customer names, phone numbers and amounts on real documents.

19

Motion

Motion explains cause and effect. It never entertains.

Principles and timings

Micro (hover, press)	`120ms`, standard ease
Standard (toggle, menu)	`180ms`
Enter (panel, sheet)	`240ms`, 6px travel + fade
Exit	`160ms`, faster than enter
Easing	Standard `cubic-bezier(.2,0,0,1)`; exit `cubic-bezier(.4,0,1,1)`. No bounce, no spring overshoot.

Behaviours

- **Signature "settle":** the name settles, then the H slides into place beside it (hero, app launch, video end frames). Once per session, never looping.
- **Hover:** colour and border change only; no lifting cards.
- **Loading:** skeletons in stone for layout; a thin progress bar for known duration. No spinners over 1 second without text saying what's happening.
- **Saved/synced:** a quiet inline confirmation ("Saved on this phone", then "Uploaded").
- All motion is off under `prefers-reduced-motion`.

20

Product Branding Architecture

The company brand stays dominant. Each product owns one colour and nothing else.



Hemlo
Studio

هيملو
ستوديو

Hemlo
Systems

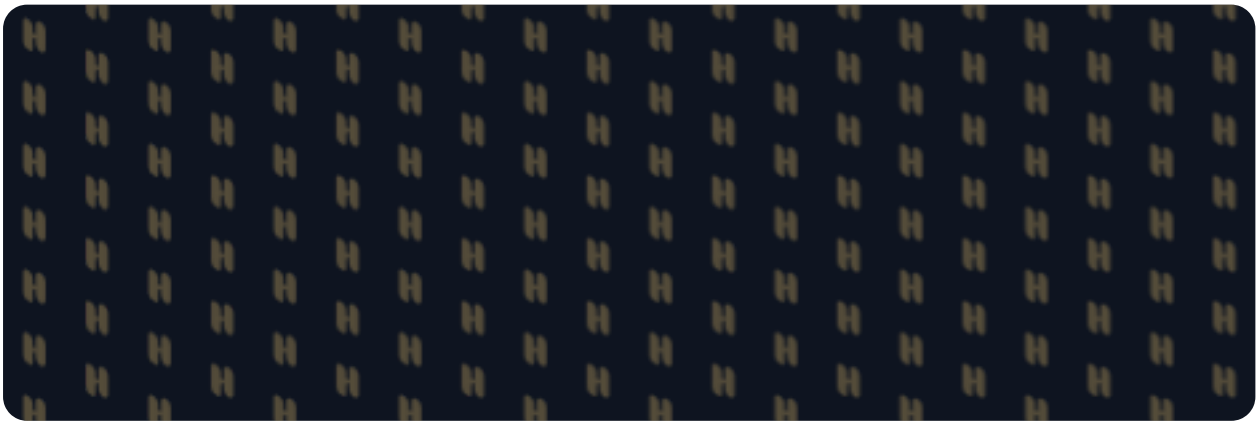
هيملو
الأنظمة

Hemlo
School

هيملو
المدارس

Brand pattern: the H monogram

The H repeated in offset rows, like a woven label or a lining fabric. Use it at 8–22% opacity for backgrounds, packaging, slides, bags and banners. Never behind body text, and never with the mark on top of it at full strength.



ELEMENT	INHERITED FROM HEMLO	OWNED BY THE PRODUCT
Logo	The H and "Hemlo" (Poppins SemiBold) in ink	The H in the branch colour; the branch name under "Hemlo" in Poppins Light
Typography	All families and scales	Nothing
Colour	Ink, neutrals, semantic, charts	One accent: active navigation, the mark and illustration highlights
Navigation	Account switcher, Hemlo header, settings, help in the same places	Its own section list
Iconography	Lucide set and rules	A few domain icons on the same grid
Dashboard style	Summary first, tables second, status chips, empty states in the brand voice	Its own key numbers and default views
Motif	The soft divider (a 2px gap between panels instead of hairlines in hero areas)	Nothing

21

Website Direction

CHOSEN

A · Field-notes editorial

Stone background, large Schibsted headlines, documentary photos of the work, product screens set in quiet frames. Motion: the hero "fit" and nothing else. It suits a company whose proof is understanding.

B · Product-native

Screens first, dark UI, dense feature grids. Strong for a single product; wrong for a company whose products don't exist yet and whose story is its method.

C · Bold Iraqi tech

Large brass and ink colour fields, oversized Arabic display type, poster energy. Memorable, but loud, and it would date quickly. Keep a little of it for campaign pages only.

22

Website Homepage Concept

BLOCK	CONTENT
Navigation	Mark + Hemlo · Products · How we build · Field notes · About · العربية / English · **Talk to us** (WhatsApp number shown as text + contact form)
Hero	**Elegantly solved.** Software that earns its place. Focused tools for the everyday work of Iraqi businesses, built after we've watched the work being done. CTAs: **See our products** · Talk to us
Company idea	A documentary photo of a debt notebook next to a phone, with one line: "Most businesses already have a system. We build software for the parts of it that cost you money."
Products	One card per product: accent-coloured mark, name, the one job in a sentence, status (Live / In pilot / Researching), "Who it's for". Researching products are shown honestly as research.
How we build	Four steps with real artefacts: **Watch** the work → **Do it by hand** for a few businesses → **Build** only what worked → **Stay** only if it's used.
Iraqi focus	The details that prove it: IQD without decimals, landmark addresses, Arabic and Kurdish, WhatsApp delivery, works offline, FIB/ZainCash/cash.
Credibility	Field notes (published research), the founder's name and face, response time, where data is stored. Customer logos only with permission and only when real.
Closing CTA	"Tell us how your work runs today. We'll tell you honestly if software would help."
Footer	Products · Company (About, Field notes, Careers) · Support (Help, Status, Contact) · Legal (Privacy, Terms, Data) · Baghdad, Iraq · bilingual lockup

23

Social Media System

Five fixed formats. Everything posted is one of them.

FIELD NOTE

Every shop we visited kept debts in the same notebook.

Photo slot: notebook and phone on a counter, Baghdad

Hemlo
Tools

PRODUCT UPDATE

Deposit schedule: export for your accountant in one tap.

PROBLEM → PRODUCT

Before: 14 receipts, 3 WhatsApp chats, 1 Excel file.

After: one shipment file.

من الدفتر إلى النظام.

PLATFORM	ROLE	LANGUAGE	LOOK
LinkedIn	Founder posts, field notes, launches, hiring	English first, Arabic second	Text-led, one image or document carousel
Instagram	Field notes, problem → product, short screen videos	Arabic first	Documentary photos, five formats only
X	Build notes, release notes, short observations	Both	Plain text, occasional screenshot

PLATFORM	ROLE	LANGUAGE	LOOK
WhatsApp Business	Sales and support: the channel customers actually use	Arabic first	Mark on ink as avatar; greeting, away message and product catalogue written in the brand voice
GitHub	Open tools (Iraqi phone/IQD formatting, RTL helpers), engineering credibility	English	Mark avatar, clear READMEs

The two formats not shown are the **Founder log** (text-only on stone, one idea per post) and **Release notes** (a product-accent header and a plain list).

24

Brand Applications

Real uses, drawn at working fidelity. Names, amounts and addresses are samples.

BUSINESS CARD · 85 × 55 MM, ENGLISH FRONT / ARABIC BACK





INVOICE · A4, BILINGUAL HEADER

Hemlo

Invoice · فاتورة

HML-INV-2026-0017 · 01 Nov 2026

Billed to Nahr Trading Co. (sample), Baghdad

ITEM	AMOUNT (IQD)
Hemlo Shipments, Team plan, November	150,000
2026 shipment file setup	250,000
Total	**400,000**

Pay by FIB transfer or cash. Questions: support on WhatsApp.

QR EQUIPMENT / FILE STICKER · 60 × 40 MM, WEATHERPROOF

Hemlo

Scan for service history

امسح لعرض سجل الصيانة

AC-0142

APP ICON AND FAVICON



App icon: the H in white (or brass) on ink, at 62% of the tile. Favicon: the same H at 16–48px. Social avatars (WhatsApp, Instagram, LinkedIn) crop to a circle; the tall H sits well inside it with nothing cut off.

PRODUCT DASHBOARD · ARABIC, RIGHT TO LEFT

هيملو

الشحنات

كل الشحنات

جدول الأمانات

الموردون

الشحنات

رقم الشحنة	المورّد	الأمانات الضريبية	الحالة
SHP-0142	قوانغتشو	3,400,000	مطابقة
SHP-0143	إسطنبول	1,150,000	ينقص وصل
SHP-0144	دبي	—	قيد الإعداد

EMAIL SIGNATURE AND PROPOSAL COVER

Your Name · Founder, Hemlo

+964 7XX XXX XXXX · hemlohq.com

Hemlo

PROPOSAL · NOV 2026

Shipment files for Nahr Trading (sample)

Also covered by the same rules

PDF reports: white pages, ink headings, brass only in the cover mark, page numbers in mono. **Signage:** the bilingual stacked lockup in ink on stone or brushed metal; brass only at the entrance. **Social profiles:** the mark on ink as the avatar and the "fit" frame as the cover. **Packaging:** not needed; QR stickers and printed onboarding cards are the only physical items.

Domain: `hemlohq.com` is registered by submitting company documents to the .iq registry, so start that paperwork alongside company registration. Until it is approved, secure a .com or .app fallback, and redirect it to .iq once .iq is live. Iraqi customers trust .iq, and it matches "Iraq-first".

25

Design Tokens

Semantic names for Next.js and Tailwind (map these CSS variables in `tailwind.config` or with Tailwind v4 `@theme`).

Copy tokens

```
/* Primitives */
--ink-950:#0E1420; --ink-700:#2B3445; --slate-500:#5E6776; --slate-400:#8A919C;
--stone-50:#F7F7F4; --stone-100:#EFEFEA; --stone-200:#E2E2DB; --stone-300:#CBCBC2;
--night-900:#0C111A; --night-800:#131A26; --night-700:#1A2230; --night-600:#283243;
--brass-300:#D7B46A; --brass-500:#B38B3A; --brass-700:#8A6A22;
--green-700:#1F7A4D; --amber-700:#B8520A; --red-700:#B42331; --blue-700:#2F5DA8;
--product-shipments:#3B5BC4; --product-service:#0F766E; --product-systems:#A8532E;
--product-school:#6E4A86; --product-retail:#5F7A2E;

/* Semantic (light) */
--color-bg:var(--stone-50);        --color-surface:#FFFFFF;
--color-surface-muted:var(--stone-100); --color-border:var(--stone-200);
--color-border-strong:var(--stone-300); --color-text:var(--ink-950);
--color-text-muted:var(--slate-500);    --color-primary:var(--ink-950);
--color-primary-fg:#FFFFFF;         --color-accent:var(--brass-500);
--color-accent-text:var(--brass-700);   --color-focus:var(--brass-500);
--color-success:var(--green-700);   --color-warning:var(--amber-700);
--color-danger:var(--red-700);      --color-info:var(--blue-700);
--color-product:var(--product-shipments); /* set per product */

/* Semantic (dark) — [data-theme="dark"] and prefers-color-scheme */
--color-bg:var(--night-900); --color-surface:var(--night-700);
```

```
--color-surface-muted:var(--night-800); --color-border:var(--night-600);
--color-text:#E9EAE6; --color-text-muted:#A3ABB8;
--color-primary:#E9EAE6; --color-primary-fg:var(--ink-950);
--color-accent:var(--brass-300); --color-accent-text:var(--brass-300);

/* Type */
--font-display:"Readex Pro", system-ui, sans-serif;
--font-sans:"IBM Plex Sans", system-ui, sans-serif;
--font-mono:"IBM Plex Mono", ui-monospace, monospace;
--font-ar-display:"Vazirmatn", Tahoma, sans-serif;
--font-ar:"Vazirmatn", Tahoma, sans-serif;
--text-xs:12px; --text-sm:13px; --text-base:14px; --text-md:16px; --text-lg:18px;
--text-xl:20px; --text-2xl:24px; --text-3xl:32px; --text-4xl:40px; --text-5xl:56px;
--leading-tight:1.1; --leading-ui:1.45; --leading-body:1.6; --leading-ar:1.8;

/* Space (4px base) */
--space-1:4px; --space-2:8px; --space-3:12px; --space-4:16px; --space-5:20px;
--space-6:24px; --space-8:32px; --space-10:40px; --space-12:48px; --space-16:64px;

/* Radius (soft, like the rounded ends of the H; full round for avatars and status dots
--radius-sm:6px; --radius-md:10px; --radius-lg:14px; --radius-xl:20px; --radius-full:99

/* Borders, shadows */
--border-width:1px; --seam:2px;
--shadow-sm:0 1px 2px rgb(14 20 32 / .06);
--shadow-md:0 2px 4px rgb(14 20 32 / .06), 0 8px 24px rgb(14 20 32 / .08);

/* Motion */
--duration-micro:120ms; --duration-standard:180ms; --duration-enter:240ms; --duration-e
--ease-standard:cubic-bezier(.2,0,0,1); --ease-exit:cubic-bezier(.4,0,1,1);

/* Breakpoints */
--bp-sm:640px; --bp-md:768px; --bp-lg:1024px; --bp-xl:1280px;
```

Rules: components use only semantic tokens. Buttons 10px radius, cards 14px, dialogs 20px (soft, to match the rounded ends of the H). One shadow level per screen. Set `dir` and `lang` on `<html>`, and use logical CSS properties (`margin-inline-start`, `ps-*`/`pe-*` in Tailwind) everywhere.

26

Brand Guidelines Structure

The chapter list for the PDF. Each chapter maps to a section of this document.

1. Brand story (07)

2. Purpose (02)
3. Mission (03)
4. Vision (03)
5. Positioning (01, 02)
6. Audience (04)
7. Personality (05)
8. Voice (10)
9. Logo (12)

10. Logo construction (12)
11. Clear space and minimum size (12)
12. Misuse (12)
13. Colours (14)
14. Typography (15)
15. Arabic and Kurdish system (16)
16. Iconography (17)
17. Imagery (18)

18. Motion (19)
19. Product architecture (20)
20. Product naming (08)
21. Web (21, 22)
22. Social (23)
23. Print (24)
24. Accessibility: contrast ratios, focus, RTL, reduced motion (14, 19, 25)
25. Brand examples (24)

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Competitive Inspiration

What to learn from each, and what not to copy. These are observations of public brand behaviour, not audits.

BRAND	WHAT MAKES IT RECOGNISABLE	PARENT ⇔ PRODUCT	LESSON FOR HEMLO
Linear	Extreme restraint; product quality is the brand	Single product	Craft in the product beats decoration. Don't copy the dark-purple look.

BRAND	WHAT MAKES IT RECOGNISABLE	PARENT ⇔ PRODUCT	LESSON FOR HEMLO
Stripe	Documentation-grade clarity; editorial writing	"Stripe Billing", "Stripe Terminal"	Architecture A works when every product is excellent. Skip the gradients.
Vercel	Monochrome precision, a strong geometric mark	Platform + features	A simple mark can carry a whole company.
Notion	Humane illustration, friendly monochrome	Single product with add-ons	Warmth without colour noise.
Shopify	Merchant-first language; a clear ecosystem	"Shopify POS", "Shopify Payments"	Speak the customer's trade language.
Atlassian	A unified logo system across many products	Independent names with shared icon rules	A shared mark grammar keeps a portfolio coherent.
Zoho	Huge breadth under one name	"Zoho CRM", "Zoho Books", 50+ apps	The warning: Architecture A dilutes if quality varies. Launch products slowly.
HubSpot / Jobber / ServiceTitan	Friendly, trade-specific tone; HubSpot's orange	Hubs / single product	Plain talk to trades people. Keep brass clearly away from orange.
Figma	Colourful multi-shape mark tied to collaboration	Figma + FigJam, Dev Mode	One mark that products can colour lets a portfolio stay one family. Hemlo does this by colouring the H.
Careem, Salla, Zid, Foodics (region)	Arabic-first names; bilingual wordmarks treated as equals	Mostly single platforms	Arabic treated as a first-class identity is now the regional standard.
Iraqi software (Geno, Mandubi, local ERPs)	Mostly generic: stock blue, stock icons, feature lists	Single products	Almost nobody in Iraqi B2B software has a considered identity. A calm, crafted one stands out immediately.

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What Makes Hemlo Distinctive

A mark that is also a product system

The H is always Hemlo; in a product lockup it takes the product colour, so the logo shows who made it and which product it is. The logo explains the company structure without words.

A concept tied to real behaviour

"Earns its place" is a test the company runs on itself, not a slogan. It shapes the roadmap, the copy and the website's honest "Researching" labels.

Iraqi through details

Dinars without decimals, landmark addresses, notebooks in the photography, Sorani-ready type. No lions, no cuneiform.

A palette nobody in the category owns

Kohl ink and Safafeer brass: serious, warm, crafted, and far from tech blue, fintech green and startup purple.

Documentary proof instead of stock promises

The workaround photographed as it is. Research published as field notes.

Bilingual by design

Arabic copy is written, not translated, with its own tagline.

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Things Hemlo Should Never Become

- A software agency that builds anything for anyone
- A one-size-fits-all ERP with a module for everything
- A brand that claims "first", "leading" or "AI-powered" as its identity
- A government-looking portal: seals, flags, all caps, dense forms
- A gradient-and-glow startup page
- A logo system where every product invents its own mark
- A company whose Arabic is an afterthought
- A brand that shows customers it doesn't have
- Noisy: pop-ups, confetti, countdown timers
- Cheap: discount banners and "limited offer" pressure

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Five-Year Brand Evolution

STAGE	BRAND FOCUS	WHAT CHANGES
Year 1: one product	Hemlo and its first product feel like one thing. The founder is the face.	Website shows the method, one live product and research in progress.
Years 2–3: two to four products	"By Hemlo" becomes a quality signal. Field notes become a recognised publication.	Product accents appear; shared account and billing; customer stories with permission.
Years 4–5: portfolio and region	Known in Iraq as the company that builds software people keep using. Possible expansion to nearby Arabic-speaking markets.	Kurdish fully live; an Iraq-specific line appears on local marketing instead of in the core tagline.

What must never change

- The H exactly as drawn, always one solid colour
- Ink as the primary colour; brass as a rare signature
- The type families and the Arabic-first writing standard
- The "earns its place" test for every product
- Plain voice, exact numbers

What may flex

- Product accents (a new one per product, from the defined range)
- Campaign lines and seasonal art direction
- Photography subjects as industries change
- Illustration, if it is ever needed, drawn on the 24-unit grid

Hemlo

Final brand direction

Brand essence	Earns its place.
Positioning	For Iraqi businesses whose daily work runs on WhatsApp, notebooks and spreadsheets, Hemlo builds focused software products, each designed around one job studied in real workplaces, that do that job completely and fit how Iraqi businesses actually operate.
Mission	Build focused software for the everyday work of Iraqi businesses, one real problem at a time.
Vision	A family of products businesses across Iraq rely on daily, where "by Hemlo" means built by people who understood the work.

Tagline	Elegantly solved. · حلولٌ بإتقان. Supporting line: Software that earns its place.
Logo concept	The founder's single soft H: two swelling stems joined by a crossbar that slopes down to the right, like fabric turned and stitched at a hem. One shape, one colour; in product lockups it takes the product colour.
Primary colours	Kohl Ink #0E1420 · Safafeer Brass #B38B3A · Stone #F7F7F4 / #E2E2DB · Slate #5E6776
Typography	Poppins (the name beside the H: SemiBold; branch names: Light) · Readex Pro (display) · IBM Plex Sans + Mono (text, data) · Vazirmatn + Vazirmatn (Arabic and Kurdish)
Personality	Grounded, precise, calm, plain-spoken, curious, dependable
Naming	Hemlo + branch (Hemlo Tools, Studio, Systems, School), the branch name under "Hemlo" in Poppins Light. Arabic: هيملو over الأنظمة
Visual style	Field-notes editorial: stone grounds, ink type, documentary photography of real work, 10–14px radii, quiet motion with one signature "fit"

Hemlo is an Iraqi software company that builds small, focused products for the everyday work of businesses. It studies how work is really done (the notebooks, the WhatsApp groups, the stamped receipts) and builds software only for the parts that cost people time or money. Its identity is calm and exact: an ink-and-brass palette, a mark made of two pieces that fit, and a voice that speaks plainly in Arabic and English. Every product carries the same promise: software that earns its place.